AI Explorers

Educator Quick-Start Guide — everything you need to teach Module 1 with confidence.

📚 **No CS background required** · ✅ **Ready in <30 min**

🤖 What Is AI Explorers?

1. **A hands-on AI curriculum** for middle and high school students — they build, experiment, and reflect, not just read or watch.
2. **Powered by OpenClaw**, a real AI agent students interact with directly — turning abstract concepts into something you can actually poke and prod.
3. **Structured in modules** (~3 weeks each), covering how AI works, how to use it responsibly, and how to make it actually do things.

🧰 What You Need

HARDWARE

Just a browser

No installs. No IT ticket. Works on any device with a modern browser.

ACCOUNTS

GitHub + OpenClaw

GitHub: free, for lesson materials. OpenClaw: provided by your school or district.

YOUR TIME

~2 hrs before Day 1

Then ~30 min/week prep. 45–50 min class sessions, 3–5x per week.

PER MODULE

~3 weeks

Standard pace. Sprint and extended options also available (see Pacing).

✅ Day 1 Checklist

Do these 10 things before your first class.

1. ⭐ **Star the repo** → github.com/clawdawg36-cpu/openclaw-curriculum so you can find it fast
2. 📂 **Browse the file structure** — open `modules/module-01/` and see what's there
3. 📖 **Read the Module 1 Teacher Guide** — `modules/module-01/teacher-guide.md`, takes ~20 min
4. 🤖 **Log into OpenClaw** — confirm your credentials work before class day
5. 👩‍🎓 **Create student accounts** (or confirm IT has) — students need OpenClaw access on Day 1
6. 🖥️ **Test OpenClaw in your browser** — open it, type a message, see a response
7. 📝 **Print or share the student handout** — found in `modules/module-01/handouts/`
8. ⏱️ **Review the first lesson plan** — `lessons/lesson-01.md` — estimate timing for your class length
9. ❓ **Read the Top 5 Teacher Questions** below in this guide
10. 💬 **Join the community** — post and say hi (link in the "Where to Get Help" section)

📋 Module 1 at a Glance

Theme: What is AI, and how does it work?

Lesson Sequence

#	TITLE	KEY ACTIVITY
1	What Is AI?	Students brainstorm where AI shows up in daily life
2	How AI Learns	Visual demo: training data and pattern recognition
3	Talk to an Agent	First OpenClaw session — students ask it questions
4	Prompting 101	Experiment: how does wording change the answer?
5	🔬 The Lab	Build a simple AI-powered task with OpenClaw
6	Reflect + Share	Groups present; class discussion on what they learned

The Lab (Lesson 5)

The lab is the centerpiece of Module 1. Students choose from scaffolded project options and use OpenClaw to complete them. Browser-based. No coding required for the base options.

Option A: Build a homework helper prompt

Option B: Create a Q&A bot for a topic they care about

Option C: Design a "responsible AI" policy for a fake school app

📂 How to Use the Materials

File Structure

```
openclaw-curriculum/
├── modules/
│   ├── module-01/
│   │   ├── teacher-guide.md        ← Start here
│   │   ├── lessons/
│   │   │   ├── lesson-01.md
│   │   │   ├── lesson-02.md
│   │   │   └── ...
│   │   ├── handouts/               ← Print or share digitally
│   │   ├── lab/                    ← Lab instructions + rubric
│   │   └── assessments/            ← Quizzes, reflection prompts
│   └── module-02/ ...
├── website/                        ← This site
└── README.md                       ← Project overview
```

What's in Each Folder

FOLDER / FILE	WHAT IT CONTAINS
`teacher-guide.md`	Full context, learning objectives, pacing notes, teaching tips
`lessons/`	Day-by-day plans with timing, discussion questions, slide notes
`handouts/`	Student-facing materials — printable or screen-friendly
`lab/`	Lab brief, scaffolded steps, extension challenges, rubric
`assessments/`	Low-stakes checks for understanding + end-of-module reflection

⏱️ Pacing Options

Pick what fits your schedule. All options cover the same core content.

✦ Recommended

Standard

3 wks

3–4 sessions/week

Allows time for reflection, discussion, and iteration. Best for most classroom settings.

Sprint

1 wk

Daily (5 days)

Great for workshops, summer programs, or intensives. Focus on lessons 1, 3, 4, 5. Skip some extensions.

Extended

4 wks

2–3 sessions/week

Best for less frequent class schedules. Add discussion depth, let lab run two sessions, bring in guests.

❓ Top 5 Teacher Questions

> **"Do I need to know how to code?"**
>
> Nope. Zero coding required to teach this curriculum. Extension challenges exist for students who want to go deeper, but you don't need to lead that.

> **"What if OpenClaw gives a weird or wrong answer?"**
>
> That's a teaching moment! AI makes mistakes. Part of the curriculum is learning to evaluate AI outputs critically. When it happens, lean in: *"Why do you think it said that? Is that right?"*

> **"How do I manage 30 students all using OpenClaw at once?"**
>
> Each student has their own session — no shared state to worry about. For lab days, consider pair work (one account per pair) to make discussion richer and reduce simultaneous sessions.

> **"What if a student asks OpenClaw something inappropriate?"**
>
> OpenClaw has built-in safety filters. If something slips through, use it as a teaching moment about responsible AI — that's literally what this curriculum is about.

> **"Can I skip a lesson if we're behind?"**
>
> Yes, with care. Lessons 1, 3, and 5 (the Lab) are the backbone — don't skip those. Lessons 2, 4, and 6 can be shortened or combined. The teacher guide flags essential vs. enrichment sections.

🆘 Where to Get Help

📌 **GitHub Issues**	Report bugs, request clarifications, suggest improvements → github.com/clawdawg36-cpu/openclaw-curriculum/issues
💬 **Discussions**	Ask questions, share what worked, get feedback from other educators → GitHub Discussions tab on the repo
📖 **README.md**	Project overview, setup instructions, and contribution guide — always up to date
👥 **Community**	*Teacher Slack/community coming soon — link will be added when it launches*

Ready? Let's Go. 🎉

Three steps stand between you and your first AI Explorers class.

⭐ **Step 1 — Star the repo**

📖 **Step 2 — Read the teacher guide**

✅ **Step 3 — Complete your Day 1 checklist**

Open the Curriculum on GitHub →

AI Explorers is open source. Contributions welcome. Made with ❤️ for educators figuring this out alongside their students.